

AUTHORITY DIAGNOSTIC

SAMPLE REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

This is a sample of the report every Authority Diagnostic client receives. The company below is invented to show the work — real reports run on your real numbers, your real ads, and your real market. For \$750, you get this: a straight read on where your authority and your ad spend are leaking money, and the prioritized fix. No call required to find out the price. This is the price.

THE ONE-LINE VERDICT

**You're paying \$142 a lead
for a problem that costs \$0
to diagnose.**

Summit Comfort isn't losing in the auction. It's losing in the first three seconds. The ads run, the budget spends, and the creative gives nobody a reason to stop. Fix the creative and the positioning behind it, and the same budget produces two to three times the leads. The detail is below.

01 / SNAPSHOT

Where You Stand Today

NEEDS WORK

AUTHORITY SCORE

38/100

Generic positioning. No proof on the page. Sounds like every other HVAC company in the metro.

HOOK RATE

16%

Target is 25–30%. Most viewers scroll past in the first second.

LINK CTR

0.6%

Target is 1.0%+. The few who watch aren't clicking.

COST PER LEAD

\$142

A healthy HVAC range is \$35–\$75. You're paying roughly double.

Your Ad Account, Read Against Benchmark

Every metric tells you where in the funnel the money leaks. Read top to bottom — the problem shows up early and compounds.

METRIC	YOUR NUMBER	HEALTHY RANGE	THE READ
CPM (cost per 1,000)	\$19	\$10–\$25	Fine. You're not overpaying for reach.
Hook rate (3-sec view)	16%	25–30%	The leak starts here. Weak opening.
Hold rate (50%+ view)	9%	15–20%	Nobody stays for the message.
Link CTR	0.6%	1.0%+	Low, but downstream of the hook.
Frequency	4.2	under 2.5	Same people, same tired ad. Fatigue.
Landing opt-in	22%	20–30%	The page converts. The traffic is the problem.
Cost per lead	\$142	\$35–\$75	The symptom. Everything above is the cause.

THE DIAGNOSIS

Your landing page is fine — it converts 22% of the people who reach it. Your reach is fine — CPM is normal. The bleed is the creative and the frequency. A 16% hook rate means 84 of every 100 people scroll past before your message starts, so the algorithm shows the same ad to the same shrinking pool until frequency hits 4.2 and they're sick of it. You're not buying bad traffic. You're sending good budget into a video that doesn't earn the first second.

Why The Creative Falls Flat

A weak hook is a positioning problem wearing a creative costume. Here's what the ad and the website are actually saying — and what they're not.

You lead with yourself, not the viewer

The current ad opens "Summit Comfort has served the metro for 20 years with quality HVAC service." Nobody scrolling Facebook at 9pm cares how long you've existed. They care that their house is 84 degrees and they don't know who to trust. The first line should name their problem, not your résumé.

Zero proof a stranger can verify

"Quality service" and "trusted technicians" are claims, not proof. There's no number, no named result, no specific story. The 2026 buyer expects evidence before they ever call. A single line — "1,900 systems serviced in Sarpy County last year" — does more than every adjective on the page.

The CTA asks for commitment too early

"Call now to schedule your appointment" asks a cold viewer to phone a stranger. That's a big first step. A lower-friction CTA — a free duct-health check, a "what's your AC actually costing you" guide — gets the lead into the funnel before asking them to pick up the phone.

One ad, one angle, running for nine weeks

There's a single creative carrying the whole account. No variation means no testing, and no testing means frequency climbs and performance decays with nothing fresh to rotate in. This is why the Ad Creative Tournament exists — you need a bench, not a star.

04 / THE FIX **What To Change, In Order**

PRESCRIPTION

Prioritized by impact per dollar. Do them top to bottom. The first one alone should move your cost per lead more than anything else on the list.

FIX 01 — BIGGEST LEVER

Rewrite the hook

Open on the viewer's problem in the first second. "Your AC is running all day and your house still won't cool — here's what's actually wrong." Problem first, you second.



FIX 02

Add one hard proof point

A real, specific number a stranger can believe. Systems serviced, years of same-day callbacks, a named neighborhood. One fact beats ten adjectives.



FIX 03

Lower the CTA

Trade "call now" for a low-friction first step — a free check or a short guide — then follow up. Get the lead before you ask for the phone call.



FIX 04

Build a creative bench

Three to five angles in rotation so frequency stays low and the algorithm always has something fresh. Test, keep winners, kill losers.

REWRITE — BEFORE & AFTER (THE OPENING LINE)

BEFORE: "Summit Comfort has served the metro for 20 years with quality HVAC service and trusted technicians. Call now to schedule."

AFTER: "Your AC's been running since noon and the house still won't drop below 80. Before you spend \$400 on a service call that doesn't fix it — here's the one thing most Sarpy County homeowners miss. We've caught it on 1,900 systems. Grab the free 2-minute duct check below."

05 / THE MATH **What The Fix Is Worth**

PROJECTION

Conservative estimate, same budget. Moving the hook rate into a healthy range pulls every downstream number with it.

Monthly ad budget (unchanged)	\$3,000
Leads today @ \$142 CPL	~21 leads/month
Hook rate after fix	16% → ~27%
Projected CPL after fix	~\$60-\$70
Projected leads, same budget	~43-50 leads/month
Net effect	Roughly 2× the leads for the money you already spend

THE POINT OF THE \$750

You just saw the leak, the cause, and the fix — on a sample. On your real account, this report pays for itself the first month the cost per lead drops. That's the whole idea of the Diagnostic: you don't guess whether the marketing's broken, you get the read for the price of a service call.

06 / NEXT Two Ways Forward

YOUR CALL

DO IT YOURSELF

Take this and run

Everything above is yours. Hand it to whoever runs your ads and start with Fix 01. No upsell required — the Diagnostic stands on its own. Plenty of people take the report and never call us again. That's fine. The report was the deal.

HAND IT TO US

Let Churlish build the fix

If you'd rather not run the creative tournament and the rewrite yourself, that's what the Authority Engine does — story-driven video, direct-response ads, and the positioning underneath them. The Diagnostic credits toward your first month. The path from here is Engine or System.

THE CHURLISH PROMISE

We tell you what's wrong before we sell you the fix.

Most agencies hide the diagnosis behind a "discovery call" and a proposal. We put it in writing for \$750 and let you decide what to do with it. That's the whole brand: proof before promise, the problem named before the pitch. If the report's good, you'll know exactly why working with us is the obvious next step. And if you just take it and go — you still got your money's worth.